

Fixed test data — Job Spec

Use this job spec as the input data for your app. This is a fictional job posting created for the purposes of this assessment (not a real Skreen role) — its only purpose is to give every candidate the same scoring inputs.

Backend Engineer — Payments Infrastructure

Company: Northbridge Finance (fictional, for this exercise)

We're looking for a Backend Engineer to join our Payments Infrastructure team, building the systems that process transactions for our merchant customers.

Requirements

- 4+ years of professional backend engineering experience, primarily in Python or Go.
- Experience designing and operating distributed systems / microservices in production.
- Strong relational database experience — schema design, query optimization, and data modelling, ideally with PostgreSQL.
- Experience designing and maintaining APIs (REST or gRPC) consumed by other services or external partners.
- Automated testing and CI/CD pipeline experience — we ship multiple times a day and rely on strong test coverage.
- Comfortable working with cloud infrastructure (AWS preferred: ECS/EKS, RDS, S3, CloudWatch).
- Experience with, or strong interest in, payments processing, financial systems, or handling data under strict compliance requirements (e.g. PCI-DSS).
- Strong written and verbal communication — you'll work closely with product, compliance, and support teams who are not engineers.

Nice-to-have

- Experience with event-driven architectures (Kafka, SQS, or similar).
- Experience carrying production on-call and responding to incidents.
- Exposure to fraud detection, reconciliation, or ledger systems.